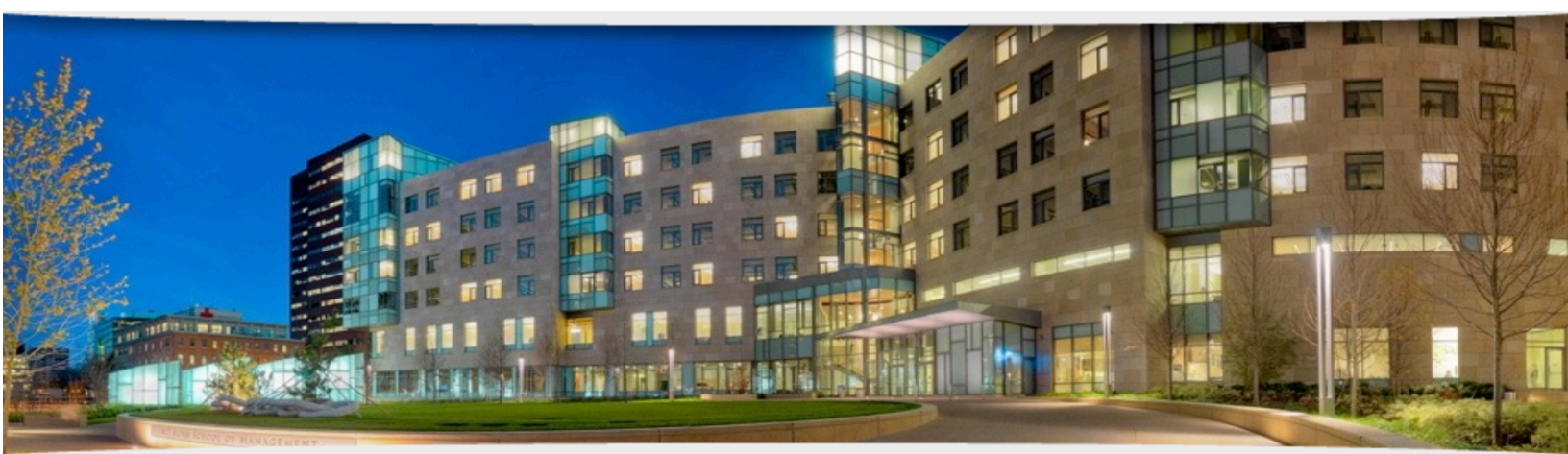




FORTUNA ADMISSIONS
INSIDER'S TOP TIPS
FOR APPLYING TO
MIT SLOAN

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ABOUT THE SCHOOL

MIT Sloan has a very different feel from its neighbor across the Charles River – the campus is more urban and industrial, with an informal mish-mash of architectural styles and a few green spaces. The Sloan School, unlike Harvard, does not have its own library, but rather shares it with the university. So there are more opportunities to mix with students from the rest of MIT.

Several well-known financial and managerial theories were developed through MIT Sloan. There is a strong analytical and data-driven focus here, especially in the core classes, and this is combined with an emphasis on innovation. Students only take one semester of core classes so there is a lot of flexibility to focus on electives. The smaller size of the student body means that the collaborative and energetic culture of innovation counts for a lot.

MIT Sloan is about invention and "ideas that are made to matter." Notable companies founded by MIT Sloan alumni include: E*Trade, Gartner, Genentech, HubSpot, InVivo Therapeutics, Teradyne, and Zipcar.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

Known for its emphasis on innovation, technology, and entrepreneurship. The school is also very strong in production/operations, finance, big data, energy, manufacturing, and information systems.

INCOMING CLASS

Number of Applicants: 5,560	MBA Class Size: 409
Admissions Selectivity: 11.5%	Yield: 60.68%
Total Tuition: \$148,400	

POST-MBA CAREERS

Sector: Consulting 31.6%; Tech 29.4%, Finance 16.4%, Starting a Business 9.7%;
Top Recruiters: Amazon, McKinsey, BCG, Bain, Deloitte, Microsoft, Facebook, Anheuser-Busch
Avg. Base Salary: \$128,301 Employment within 3 months: 97%

MBA RANKINGS

	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
BusinessWeek	9	9	14	4	7	3	4
Financial Times	5	5	5	5	7	7	6
Forbes	–	12	–	9	–	8	–
The Economist	7	9	10	12	12	15	14
US News	4	4	5	5	5	4	5

ADMISSIONS

Avg. Work Exp.: 4.9 yrs	Avg. GMAT: 728	Avg. GPA: 3.48
Int'l Students: 38%	Women: 42%	

Deadlines for 2019-2020: R1- Oct. 1, '19 R2- Jan 21, '20 R3 - Apr 9, '20

Sources: MIT Sloan, BusinessWeek, Financial Times, US News, MBA50



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ESSAYS 2019/2020:

MIT Sloan's requirements buck the M7 standard by sidestepping traditional written essays and soliciting a cover letter, video statement and - new in 2019 - an org chart.

COVER LETTER: MIT Sloan seeks students whose personal characteristics demonstrate that they will make the most of the incredible opportunities at MIT, both academic and non-academic. We are on a quest to find those whose presence will enhance the experience of other students. We seek thoughtful leaders with exceptional intellectual abilities and the drive and determination to put their stamp on the world. We welcome people who are independent, authentic, and fearlessly creative – true doers. We want people who can redefine solutions to conventional problems, and strive to preempt unconventional dilemmas with cutting-edge ideas. We demand integrity and respect passion.

Taking the above into consideration, please submit a cover letter seeking a place in the MIT Sloan MBA Program. Your letter should conform to a standard business correspondence, include one or more examples that illustrate why you meet the desired criteria above, and be addressed to the Assistant Deans of Admissions, Rod Garcia and Dawna Levenson (300 words or fewer, excluding address and salutation).

VIDEO STATEMENT: Please take a minute to introduce yourself to your future classmates via video. Include a bit on your past experience and why MIT Sloan is the best place for you to pursue your MBA. Videos should be a single take (no editing) lasting no more than one minute and consisting of you speaking directly to the camera. We recommend using an application such as QuickTime or iMovie to record yourself.

For additional insights on crafting a compelling video statement, view this recent article by Fortuna's Brittany Maschal: [Ace the MIT Video Statement](#).

ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

Please upload an organizational chart which outlines the internal structure of your department and company. Limit to two pages. Note: You may choose to create your own document or redact individuals' names. However, please provide as much information as possible.

We should be able to see your line of reporting to the top of your organization, and to easily find you, your peers, your supervisor, their peers, and your direct reports (should you have any), as well as any other recommenders from your current organization. For those in consulting, please submit an organizational chart of a current or previous project you were staffed on. Please use the sample organizational chart displayed in the application as a guideline.

Learn more about this new app element in a recent article by Fortuna's Heidi Hillis: [How to Navigate the New MIT Sloan Org Chart Requirement](#).



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Tip #1 - Preference for STEM background & high quant GMAT

MIT Sloan very openly favors applicants with very strong quantitative foundations and has a history of attracting (and admitting) students with science, technology, engineering and mathematics profiles – as well as those who have a record of achievement in economics. So, if you do not have this kind of academic background, you need to make sure your quant GMAT score is very strong in terms of supporting your skills. A very rapid advancement professionally also helps mitigate a weaker than average quantitative background.

Tip #2 - Action-oriented profiles

MIT Sloan is the school which pioneered action-learning – the Institute's motto of *mens et manus* (Latin for "mind and hand") also points to the philosophy that you need not only be intelligent, but you need to show you are able to successfully execute your ideas. In your application and essays, you should focus on describing detailed examples of your actions, which have contributed to your success in a substantive, concrete way.

Tip #3 - Making an impact

Making a difference matters – the Admissions Committee wants to know what you plan to do with your degree which will have a positive impact on the world. Sloan takes itself very seriously in terms of being a mission-driven institution, and it is looking for similarly minded individuals who will ultimately be able to act on this mission. Your essays should demonstrate how you view success through the lens of benefiting the world in some way.

Tip #4 - Feelings rather than function

Like many of the admissions offices at the top schools, MIT Sloan has a fairly small team to handle the many thousands of applications it receives each year. As such they have read countless applications that provide details of the tasks, projects and responsibilities of consultants, software engineers and financiers and have a pretty good idea of what those roles involve. Beyond avoiding technical jargon, avoid devoting too much space in your essays to the mechanics of your job, which provides very little insight into who you are as a person and what makes you tick. Sloan is far more interested to learn about how you thought through a particular challenge or situation, what you did to come up with an innovative solution, and how you felt when you needed to make a difficult decision. While the schools clearly value numbers and analytical skills, MIT Sloan is still trying to unearth the very human aspects of your personality, and the values, integrity and passion with which you lead your life.

Tip #5 - In pursuit of excellence

Sloan is interested in students who demonstrate excellence in terms of their work experience, academic achievements, and their goals. Make sure you highlight where you have outperformed or been an overachiever throughout your application in very measurable, concrete ways. Excellence need not only be in the professional sphere – if you are a karate black belt, master chess player, avid musician – make sure to weave that in to your application as well.



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Tip #6 – Be authentic and distinct

In addition to excellence, the Admissions Committee members are searching for authenticity – being able to explain what you want to do and why in a convincing and credible way is key to getting serious consideration. Avoid the temptation to make yourself fit a profile you think Sloan may want. You have your own unique and authentic story. Focus on where you may be able to best stand out vs. how you blend in to the masses of other MBA applicants.

Tip #7 – The relationship with MIT

Because of its emphasis on innovation, many of Sloan's alumni have made strides in terms of being entrepreneurs, particularly in the field of technology. If you have entrepreneurial ambitions, including how you plan to leverage the technical expertise of the larger MIT community, this will make you a more attractive applicant.

Don't forget, when it comes to attracting top talent Sloan goes head to head with Stanford and Haas from the west coast, and HBS just across the Charles River. So if appropriate you should articulate how the interaction with some of the world's brightest engineers and scientists, and an extraordinary ecosystem for startups matches with your MBA goals.

More about Fortuna Admissions:

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, LBS, Chicago Booth, Kellogg, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances for admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

